

not admit to owing that debt, or the statute could start up again. Silence is golden, and that silence can be a silver lining.

No Admission

Do not admit to owing any alleged debt, and sure as heck, don't send them any money. Remember what your mother told you way back when: If you can't say anything nice, don't say anything at all.

If the collector is persistent, and that is a quality inherent to their job, they may keep calling. Don't cave in. You tell them that it is not collectible and hang up; or you say that you don't remember anything about the alleged debt and hang up.

Then you send off a letter, telling them to stop calling you. A sample letter for you to use as a guideline is included in the Appendix.

Be Smart

If you were to admit to the debt, then the statute of limitations might start running all over again, because the debt has become "active" again, giving them the legal right to pursue their collections or sue you. You don't want to be close to eliminating all your debt, only to blow it by saying too much! Remember: all you have to do is tell them that the time to collect this debt has expired. End of discussion.

Be bold and be firm. These scavenger debt collectors are feeding off the waste droppings of the bottom feeders, so they stoop low. They will be aggressive and will probably identify themselves as a law firm in an effort to intimidate you. Don't be thrown off your course. Stand your ground and firmly state that the debt is beyond the statute of limitations and is not collectible.

It is a very simple strategy. Wait them out and the debt can disappear! Your credit card company wrote off your account a long time ago as uncollectible, and got a tax deduction for it! There is no right that these scavenger debt collectors have to try to collect on that old debt now.

Their scare tactics are working though, and some people pay off a debt that has passed the statute of limitations timeframe. The scoundrel